

ACTS OF APOSTLES

Who is an apostle?

Is a person who is sent off on a mission.

WHO WROTE THE BOOK OF ACTS?

- The book of Acts was written by **Luke**.
- Besides Acts , Luke also wrote the "Gospel According to Luke"

WHO WAS LUKE?

1. He was a Roman Gentile who was probably from Syria.
2. He was a man who had been converted to Christianity
3. He was a medical doctor, a historian and also a preacher.
4. He was Paul's companion.

PURPOSE OF THE BOOK OF ACTS

1. The main purpose of the book of Acts, is to show how Jesus' early followers led by the Holy Spirit, spread the Good News (Gospel) in Jerusalem, Judea Samaria as well as to the end of the earth.
2. Luke wrote the book of Acts also to make it clear that Christianity is for all (both the Jews and Gentiles).
3. Luke also wanted to make it clear that Christianity was not seditious (an act of rebellion) against Roman authority.

THE NINE THEMES

The book of Acts is best taught using the **9 themes**.

What is a theme?

- A theme is defined as Luke's special interest.

THE THEMES AND THEIR MEANING

1. God saves mankind through Jesus Christ

Meaning; It means a person is saved through his/her faith and acceptance that Jesus is the Messiah and God's son.

Note Messiah means the anointed one

- To be saved means the following;
 - ✓ to enter into the Kingdom of God through faith in the witness of the Apostles and through repentance.
 - ✓ to be freed from any evil

2. Jesus works through the Holy Spirit

Meaning; Although Jesus was taken up to heaven, he continued working in the disciples through the Holy Spirit.

MEANING OF THE HOLY SPIRIT

- ✓ It means presence of God in nature and man **or**
- ✓ It means the creative power of God at work in nature and man.

3. Jesus uses the Church as an instrument of salvation

Meaning; It means Jesus uses the community of believers to save those who have not yet received the salvation.

Church; Is the community of believers in the witness of apostles.

Characteristics of the Early Church

1. The believers followed the teachings of their apostles
2. The believers lived in fellowship by sharing goods and praying together
3. New believers were admitted through baptism and laying on of the hands
4. Local churches assisted each other
5. Local churches accepted Jerusalem and its leaders as the centre.

HOW THE CHURCH SAVES MANKIND?

- ✓ Through healing i.e. done through the disciples or apostles
- ✓ Through prayers
- ✓ Through words and actions

4. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible.

Meaning; Through the Power of the Holy Spirit, nothing could stop the spread of the gospel.

- This means that the mission of the apostles was unstoppable despite numerous obstacles they faced.

OBSTACLES THE APOSTLES /BELIEVERS FACED IN THE SPREADING OF THE GOSPEL

- ✓ The apostles faced a number of obstacles in their attempt to spread the gospel. these obstacles included

a. Imprisonment; e.g.

- ✓ Peter and John were arrested after healing a lame man at the Beautiful Gate
- ✓ Paul and Silas were jailed in Philip after delivering a demon possessed young servant woman

b. Threats; e.g.

- ✓ Peter and John were threatened not to teach in the name of Jesus any longer.

c. Persecutions; e.g.

- ✓ After the death of Stephen, believers suffered a cruel persecution in Jerusalem.

Note; Persecutions helped in the spreading of the gospel.

How?

- Due to persecutions, believers fled and got scattered to other areas from Jerusalem. In these areas they preached the gospel e.g. **Philip** escaped to Samaria where he preached the gospel and many believed his message.

d. Oppositions and persecutions by unbelieving Jews; e.g.

- ✓ Paul and Barnabas in Derbe (Acts 14:19)

- ✓ Saul in Damascus and Jerusalem (Acts 9:23,29)
- ✓ Paul and Barnabas at Antioch in Pisidia (Acts 13:45, 50)
- ✓ Paul and Barnabas at Iconium (Acts 14:2,5)

e. Natural Dangers e.g.

- ✓ Storms at the sea Acts 27:13

f. False prophets e.g.

- ✓ Paul and Barnabas met with a magician named Bar-Jesus who claimed to be a prophet (Acts 13:6-12)

g. Opposition (arguments) of the wise e.g.

- ✓ Epicurean and Stoic teachers in Athens (Acts 17:18)

h. Superstition of pagan religions

- ✓ In Lystra people worshipped their own gods (Zeus and Hermes)
- ✓ In Ephesus, the worship of god called Artemis.

i. Opposition that was inspired by greed; e.g.

- ✓ Rioting of silver smiths in Ephesus

5. The Holy Spirit guides the Church

Meaning; It means that any activity the apostles did was under the guidance of the Holy Spirit.

- a. The Holy Spirit guided the church in the choice of the seven helpers
- b. The Holy Spirit also directed the activities of the leaders
- c. The Holy Spirit controlled the decisions of the leaders

6. The church shares in the suffering of Jesus

Meaning; It means the believers had to suffer for the sake of Jesus just as Jesus himself suffered.

Examples of sufferings the believers faced

- ✓ imprisonments
- ✓ Death e.g. Stephen was stoned to death.
- ✓ Beatings; Paul and Silas in Philip

NOTE: Despite all these sufferings, the believers continued with the mission of spreading the gospel through the encouragement of the Holy Spirit.

7. Prayer is vital for the life of the church

Meaning; Everything works to the betterment of the church with prayer. Without prayer, the church cannot live.

Meaning of prayer

- ✓ It means spending time in the presence of God either alone or with others.

Reasons why people pray

The following are some of the reasons why people pray

1. To ask God for protection
2. To ask for God's favour.
3. To ask for healing if someone falls ill
4. To ask for God's forgiveness

8. The church's mission is universal (is for all people)

Meaning; The salvation of God is for all (both Jews and non Jews)

However it was to be to the Jews first

Why?

- a. Because Jews were chosen to be a light to the nations
- b. Because Jesus himself was sent to the Jews first

Why the salvation was also for the non Jews (Gentiles)?

- a. Because Jesus also cared for the Gentiles in his ministry
- b. Because Jesus directed Paul to the Gentiles
- c. It is the fulfillment of God's words foretold by prophets e.g. Deutero Isaiah (Isaiah 45:14-25)
- d. By telling his disciples that they would be his witness to the end of the earth, Jesus meant the apostles' mission would also be to the Gentiles.
- e. Jesus himself in Nazareth, hinted that salvation would be for the Gentiles rather than Jews
- f. Some of Jesus' parables indicated that salvation would go to the Gentiles e.g. Parable of the wicked tenants and parable of the great banquet.

NOTE: Gentiles who believed in Judaism but remained outside the Jewish community because they could not practise the Jewish religion rules especially circumcision are referred to as **God-fearers**

➤ In acts, the following God-fearers are mentioned

1. The Ethiopian Eunuch (eunuchs were excluded from the Jewish communities)
2. Cornelius
3. Lydia
4. Titius Justus

9. The author of acts shows sympathy to the Romans

Meaning; In both the gospel according to Luke and in acts, the author (Luke himself) has put the Romans in good light.

Why Luke put the Romans in good light in his gospel and Acts?

1. By showing sympathy to the Romans, Luke wanted to gain their sympathy for the Christian cause. In so doing he could easily convince them that;
 - a. Christianity is a respectable religion that could not pose threat to the public order
 - b. The Romans should also tolerate Christianity just as they tolerated Jewish religion.
2. Luke also wanted to show that Christianity was a friendly religion unlike the Jewish religion which showed hostile attitude towards the empire. (Christians were friendly to the Romans unlike the Jews)
3. Luke also wanted the Romans to get attracted to the Christian faith and accept it just as others had already done.

Acts 1:1-5

- Chapter one of Acts opens with a salutation (Dear Thiophilus).
- The author of Acts (Luke) then states what he wrote about Jesus in his first book (the gospel according to Luke).
- Luke also highlights the instruction that Jesus gave his disciples prior to his ascension to heaven.

What was the Instruction that Jesus gave his disciples before he ascended to heaven?

- ✓ Jesus ordered the disciples not to leave Jerusalem until they receive the Holy Spirit.

JESUS IS TAKEN UP TO HEAVEN

(Acts 1:6-11)

- Prior to his ascension to heaven, his disciples asked him whether he (Jesus) would give back the kingdom to Israel.

JESUS REPLY

- ✓ Jesus told the disciples that the time and occasions are set by his father's (God) own authority. And it was not for them to know when it would be.

But when they receive the Holy Spirit, they will be filled with power and they will be his witnesses in Jerusalem, Judea, Samaria and to the end of the earth..

- After saying this, Jesus was taken up to heaven. His disciples watched him being taken up in a vivid picture until **cloud** hid him from their sight.
- While the disciples had their eyes still fixed on the sky, suddenly two men dressed in white (the angels) appeared and stood beside them.
- The two men told the disciples not to keep on looking at the sky for Jesus, because Jesus would come back in the same way as they saw him being taken up to heaven.

Note: The **cloud** that hid Jesus symbolizes God's glory and His presence.

JUDAS' SUCCESSOR

(Acts 1:12-26)

- Then the apostles returned to Jerusalem from **Mount of Olives**. They entered the city and went to the room where they were staying. There, they gathered frequently to pray as a group together with Mary the mother of Jesus and his brothers as well as with other women.
- Some few days later, there was a meeting of believers about 120 of them. Peter stood up and addressed them.

PETER'S SPEECH TO FELOW BELIEVERS

1. Fellow believers, scriptures have come true in which the Holy Spirit speaking through David made a prediction about Judas.
2. Judas was a guide for those who arrested Jesus.
3. He was a member of our group for he was chosen to have part in our work
4. So then someone must join us as a witness to the resurrection of the Lord Jesus.
5. He must have been in Jesus' company from the time of his baptism by John until his ascension.

QUALITIES /QUALIFICATIONS OF A PROSPECTIVE JUDAS' SUCCESSOR PETER OUTLINED IN HIS SPEECH.

- ✓ The man must have been in Jesus' company from the time of his baptism by John until his ascension
- ✓ He must be able to witness that Jesus is risen.

- So the believers proposed two men;
 1. Joseph who was also called Barsabbas or Justus
 2. Matthias
- Then, they prayed to God for guidance and drew lots to choose between the two, and the one chosen was **Matthias**.
- So he was added to the group of 11 apostles to make it 12.

Theme

1. Prayer is vital for the life of the Church.

THE DAY OF PENTECOST (THE COMING OF THE HOLY SPIRIT)

- **Pentecost** is a Greek word meaning the fiftieth day after the feast of the Passover.
- In New Testament, it means the commemoration of the coming of the Holy Spirit on the believers.

WHAT HAPPENED TO THE BELIEVERS ON THE DAY OF PENTECOST?

1. When the day of Pentecost came, all believers gathered together in one place.
2. Suddenly there was a noise from the sky which sounded like a strong blowing wind. The noise filled the whole room where the believers were sitting.
3. Then the believers saw what looked like tongues of fire that spread out and touched each person and at once they were all filled with the Holy Spirit and began speaking in tongues

REACTION OF THE JEWS TO WHAT HAPPENED TO THE BELIEVERS ON THE DAY OF PENTECOST

1. When they heard the noise they came close (they gathered)

2. They were all excited because they heard believers speaking in tongues
3. They were amazed at what had happened
4. Some Jews made fun of the believers that they had drunk.

➤ Then Peter stood up with other apostles and addressed the people.

PETER'S'S SPEECH

In his address, Peter said;

1. Fellow Jews and those who live in Jerusalem listen to me
2. These people are not drunk as you think. But this is the outpouring of the Holy Spirit as foretold by Joel when he spoke of the last days
3. Jesus did mighty works; which were the signs that he came from God. But you killed him.
4. God raised him up. This should not be unbelievable to you? as it was foretold by David.
5. Jesus shares the power of God and he is the Messiah. What you see and hear is the power that he has sent.

People's reaction to Peter's speech

When the people heard what Peter said;

- a. They were deeply troubled
 - b. they asked the apostles what they could do
6. Peter told them;
 - ✓ to repent their sins
 - ✓ to be baptized in the name of Jesus so that they could receive the Holy Spirit.
- About **3000** people believed Peter's message and were baptized and added to the group of believers

Themes

1. Jesus uses the church as an instrument of salvation
2. The Holy Spirit guides the church
3. God saves mankind through Jesus
4. God's salvation is universal but first to the Jews.

LIFE AMONG THE BELIEVERS

(Acts 2:43-47)

- Believers lived a fellowship life. They would
 1. Share their belongings with one another
 2. have their meals together in their homes
 3. Share the money amongst themselves according to ones needs after selling their possessions
 4. Meet together in the temple every day

HEALING OF THE LAME MAN AT THE BEAUTIFUL GATE

(Acts 3:1-10)

- One day at three o'clock in the afternoon, Peter and John went to the temple for prayers. At the gate of the temple called the **Beautiful Gate**, there was a lame man. This man had been lame all his life (from birth). Every day, he was being carried to the Beautiful Gate to beg for money from those who were going into the temple.
- When the man saw Peter and John going into the temple, he begged them to give him something.

PETER'S RESPONSE TO THE LAME MAN'S REQUEST FOR ALMS

- ✓ Peter told the lame man that he had no money to give him but he could give him what he had.

HOW PETER HEALED THE LAME MAN AT THE BEAUTIFUL GATE?

- ✓ Peter ordered the man in the name of Jesus Christ of Nazareth to get up and walk. Then he took him by his right hand and helped him up. At once the lame man's feet and ankles became strong and he jumped up, stood on his feet and started walking around.

LAME MAN'S REACTION TO HIS HEALING

- ✓ Having seen that he had been healed, the lame man;
 1. Went into the temple with the apostles.
 2. Praised God
 3. Walked and jumped with joy.

PEOPLE'S REACTION TO THE HEALING OF THE LAME MAN

- ✓ When the people saw what had happened;
 1. They were all surprised.
 2. They ran to where the apostles and healed man were.

PETER'S SPEECH

1. Fellow Israelites, don't not get surprised at what has happened
2. It is not us but the man's faith in Jesus that has cured him
3. Pilate declared Jesus innocent but you killed him.
4. God raised him and we are the witnesses
5. You the people and the rulers acted in ignorance to fulfill what God spoke through the prophets
6. Repent then and listen to Jesus
7. God made a promise to you and if you believe it will be fulfilled and all nations will be blessed in you.

PETER AND JOHN ARE ARRESTED

- ✓ The apostles were still speaking to the people when the **priests, the officer of the temple guards** and **Sadducees** arrived.

- ✓ They were annoyed with what the two apostles had done. So they arrested them

REASONS WHY PETER AND JOHN WERE ARRESTED

1. Because there were teaching people that Jesus had risen from death. This was against the Sadducees' belief, that there was no life after death.
2. Because the apostles had healed the lame man in the name of Jesus Christ whom they condemned.

Reasons Why the Sadducees were irritated by the Apostles actions

1. Because the apostles were teaching people that Jesus had risen from death which was against the Sadducees' belief.
2. Because the apostles operated in the temple which was under their authority.
3. Because the apostles were teaching the people about Jesus whom they had condemned.
4. The Sadducees were afraid that the Apostles' actions would cause riots which would anger the Roman Authorities which were in good term with them.

Note: Some people believed Peter's message and were added to the group of believers

Themes

1. God saves mankind through Jesus
 - the lame man was healed (freed from evil)
 - People believed Peter's message and became believers
2. God uses the Church as an instrument of salvation
3. God's salvation is universal but first to the Jews.

PETER AND JOHN BEFORE THE COUNCIL

(Acts 4:1-22)

- After being arrested, the apostles were put in jail waiting for appearance before the council
- The following day the apostles were brought before the council

COMPOSITION OF THE COUNCIL

The council comprised of;

1. The Teachers of the Law
2. The Jewish leaders
3. The elders
4. High priest Annas, Caiaphas and other individuals such as Alexander and John

- Before the council the apostles were questioned.

PETER'S SPEECH BEFORE THE COUNCIL

Peter full of the Holy Spirit said;

1. Leaders of the people and elders
2. If we are being questioned about the good deed done to the lame man and how he was healed, then you should know that he has been healed through Jesus whom you crucified.
3. But God raised him from death.
4. He (Jesus) was like a rejected stone which has turned into the corner stone
5. Salvation is found in him only.

Reaction of the Council to Peter's speech

- a. When the members of the council heard Peter's speech, they were all amazed to see how bold the apostles were considering that the apostles were just ordinary men of no education.
- The members of the council then knew that the apostles had been the companions of Jesus.
 - Having seen that it was impossible for the council to punish the apostles because all people were praising God for what had happened, the council
 - warned them not to speak or teach in the name of Jesus any longer. Then the council set them free. But the apostles told the council that they would still continue.

Themes

1. The Church shares in the suffering of Jesus
 - Peter and John were imprisoned
2. Jesus works through the Holy Spirit

THE BELIEVERS PRAY FOR BOLDNESS

(Acts 4:23-31)

- Immediately after they were set free, the apostles went to their group and told them what the council had said to them. Then they all together prayed for boldness and more miracles to happen.

THINGS THAT HAPPENED AFTER THE BELIEVERS PRAYED FOR BOLDNESS

1. The place where they were meeting was shaken
2. They were all filled with the Holy Spirit.

OCCASIONS ON WHICH BELIEVERS PRAYED TOGETHER AS A GROUP

1. During the choice of Judas successor
2. During the prayer for the boldness

THE BELIEVERS SHARE THEIR POSSESSIONS

- All the believers continued living in close fellowship. They continued sharing their possessions to ensure that no one was needy amongst them. Those who owned fields or houses sold them and handed the money to the apostles to share to them according to ones need.
- A man named Joseph a Levite born in Cyprus whom the apostles called Barnabas sold his field and handed the money to the apostles

Note: Barnabas means " *One who encourages*"

ANANIAS AND SAPPHIRA

(Acts 5:1-11)

- But there was a man named **Ananias** and his wife **Sappira**. As a family, they promised to give the whole money to the church after selling their property. But after selling the property, they kept some money back for themselves while the rest they gave to the apostles. Peter asked them if the money they had presented to the apostles was the full amount they got after selling their property. Both Ananias and his wife Sapphira lied to the Peter that the money was full amount they got. This was a lie to the Holy Spirit and they all and died.

MIRACLE AND WONDERS

- The apostles performed many unusual miracles and wonders. Sick people were placed on the beds and mats in the streets so that Peter's shadow should fall on them as he passed by.
- And all the sick and those who had evil spirits in them were healed.

APOSTLES ARE PERSECUTED

(Acts 5:17-42)

- The High Priest and the Sadducees became extremely jealous of the apostles. So they arrested them and put them in jail.
- At night, the angel of the Lord opened the prison gates and led the apostles out.
- The following day, the council met and sent for the apostles to appear before them, but the messengers found no apostles in the prison. so they reported to the council. When the members of the council heard this; **they wondered what had happened to the apostles** since the prison was tightly locked but the apostles were not in.
- Then a certain man came and reported that the apostles **were in the temple teaching people**. So the officer and his men went to take the apostles. And brought them before the council where they were questioned.

NOTE. The officer and his men did not use force to take the apostles from the temple **because they were afraid that people would stone them**.

Peter and the other apostles' speech before the council

1. We must obey God and not men
2. The God of our ancestors raised Jesus whom you killed by nailing him on the cross
3. But God raised him as Leader and Saviour to give repentance and forgiveness to Israel.
4. We are the witnesses to these things.

REACTION OF THE COUNCIL TO THE APOSTLES SPEECH

- When the members of the council heard these;

1. They became furious with the apostles
 2. They wanted to have the apostles put to death.
- But one of the members of the council called **Gamaliel** was against the council's decision to have the apostles killed

WHO WAS GAMALIEL?

1. He was a Pharisee and also a distinguished teacher of the Law.
(**Note** Saul from Tarsus was one of Gamaliel's students)
 2. He was a highly respected member of the council by all people
- So Gamaliel stood up and addressed his fellow members of the council.

GAMALIEL'S SPEECH TO HIS FELLOW MEMBERS OF THE COUNCIL

1. Fellow Israelites, be careful with what you do to these men (the apostles)
 2. Remembers **Theudas** and **Judas** who came and claimed themselves great. But after their deaths, their followers scattered
 3. Therefore don't take any action against these men- leave them alone.
 4. If what they are doing is of human origin, it will disappear
 5. But if it is from God, you cannot defeat(stop) them
 6. Otherwise you could find yourself fighting against God.
- The council followed Gamaliel's advice. So they whipped the apostles and ordered them no longer to speak in the name of Jesus. Then they set them free. The apostles left happily.

Themes

1. The Church shares in the suffering of Jesus

- Apostles were imprisoned and whipped
- 2. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible
- the council tried to stop the mission of the apostles by imprisoning them

THE CHOICE OF THE SEVEN HELPERS

(Acts 6:1-7)

1. The **Hebrews** were native Palestinian Jews. These Jews spoke Aramaic as their primary language
 2. **Hellenists** were Jews who had come to Jerusalem from other countries outside Palestine. These Jews spoke Greek as their primary language. They came to settle in Jerusalem for the love of the temple and the law.
- As the number of the believers grew up, the disagreement between the Hebrews (Native Jews) and the Hellenist (Greek speaking Jews) erupted.
- Note:** All the apostles were Hebrews while the seven helpers were Hellenists except Nicolaus who was a gentile but converted to Judaism.
- ✓ This was done to ensure fairness

WHAT CAUSED THE DISAGREEMENT

- ✓ Widows belonging to the Hellenists (Greek Speaking Jews) were being neglected in the daily distribution of funds. So they presented the matter to the apostles who told the believers to choose seven men to ensure fairness in the distribution of the finances between the native Jews and Greek speaking Jews.
- So the believers chose the seven men and presented them to the apostles who prayed for them.

Qualities of the chosen seven helpers

1. They were men full of Holy Spirit
 2. They were men full of wisdom
 3. They were men full of faith e.g. Stephen
- These seven helpers were; Stephen, Philip, Prochorus, Nicanor, Timon, Parmenas, and Nicolaus a Gentile from Antioch who had been converted to Judaism.
- Their duty was to handle finances

THE ARREST OF STEPHEN – One of seven helpers

(Acts 6:8-15)

- Stephen performed great miracles and wonders among the people. However he was opposed by some **Freedmen** (Jews who were enslaved and then granted freedom). These and other Jews from Cilicia and Asia strongly argued with Stephen. But the Spirit gave Stephen such wisdom that whatever he spoke they could not refute him.
- So they bribed some men to accuse Stephen of;
1. Speaking against Moses
 2. Speaking against God - These stirred up the teachers of the Law and elders
- So they arrested Stephen and brought him before the council.

ACCUSATIONS LEVELLED AGAINST STEPHEN BEFORE THE COUNCIL

1. They accused him of talking against their sacred temple.
2. They accused him of talking against the Law of Moses.

3. They accused him of saying that Jesus of Nazareth would tear down the temple
 4. They accused him of saying that Jesus of Nazareth would change all their customs which had come down to them from Moses.
- Then the High Priest asked Stephen if these accusations leveled against him were true

STEPHEN'S SPEECH BEFORE THE COUNCIL

(Acts 7:1-53)

1. Before our ancestor Abraham went to stay in Haran, God appeared and spoke to him
2. This indicates that God does not speak to the people in the temple only.
3. He (God) is everywhere and not only in the temple.

Reaction of the members of the council to Stephen's speech

(The Stoning of Stephen- Acts 7:54-60)

- As members of the council listened to Stephen;
1. They became furious and ground their teeth at him in anger
 2. They covered their ears with their hands
 3. They all rushed at him and dragged him out of the city.
 4. They finally stoned him to death.
- Saul approved of his murder

Ways in which Stephen's death can be compared to Jesus death

1. Both Stephen and Jesus cried out in a loud voice before dying
(Luke 23:46, Acts 7:60)

2. Both Stephen and Jesus prayed for the forgiveness of those who persecuted them (Luke 23:34, Acts 7:60)
3. Both were buried by those who sympathized with them

Difference

1. Jesus died through crucifixion while Stephen died through stoning

Themes

1. The Church shares in the suffering of Jesus
2. Jesus works through the Holy Spirit
3. The Holy Spirit guides the Church

SAUL PERSECUTES THE CHURCH

(Acts 8:1-3)

Way in which Saul persecuted the church

1. By imprisoning the believers

THE GOSPEL IS PREACHED IN SAMARIA

(Acts 8:4-25)

- Saul's persecution against the church scattered all believers from Jerusalem except the apostles.
- Philip (one of the seven chosen helpers) escaped to Samaria where he boldly preached about the Messiah to the people.

- He also performed many miracles and wonders in Samaria such that;

1. Many people were delivered from evil spirits

2. Many paralyzed and lame people were healed.

✓ So **there was great joy** in the whole city of Samaria

- But there was man in Samaria named **Simon** who practiced magic. For a long time he had astounded the Samaritans with his magic and many had paid attention to him. But when Philip preached the gospel to the people, they believed him were all baptized.
- "Simon the magician" also believed Philip's message and he too was baptized.
- The apostles in Jerusalem heard that the people of Samarian had received the word of God. So they sent **Peter** and **John** to Samaria

Reason why the church in Jerusalem sent Peter and John to Samaria.

1. To pray for the believers to receive the Holy Spirit

- When the apostles (Peter and John) arrived in Samaria, they prayed for the believers and they all received the Holy Spirit.
- Simon the magician saw that the believers had received the Holy Spirit after the apostles had placed their hands on them. So he offered some money to the apostles to give him same power of giving H. Spirit to the people he would place his hands on.

PETER'S RESPONSE TO SIMON'S OFFER OF MONEY TO BUY POWER

Peter said;

1. May you and your money go to hell for thinking that you can buy God's gift with money

2. You have no share in our work because your heart is not right in God's sight.
3. Repent then of this evil plan of yours and pray that the Lord should forgive you
4. I see that you are full of bitter envy and you are also a prisoner of sin.

SIMON'S REACTION TO PETER'S MESSAGE

- When Simon the Magician heard these;
 1. He asked the apostles to pray for him so that none of what Peter said should happen to him.

Themes

1. God saves mankind through Jesus
2. The Holy Spirit guides the church

PHILIP AND THE ETHIOPIAN EUNUCH

(Acts 8:26- 38)

- Then the angel of the Lord ordered Philip to go south to the road that goes from Jerusalem to Gaza. So Philip went. and there he met with an Ethiopian eunuch who was in charge of the treasury of the queen of Ethiopia. He was on his way back home to Ethiopia from Jerusalem.

Reason Why the Ethiopian Eunuch went to Jerusalem

1. He went there to worship God.
- As he rode along in his carriage, he was reading the scriptures from the book of **Isaiah (53:7-8)** where it says;

"Like a sheep that is taken to be slaughtered,

like a lamb that makes no sound when its wool is cut off,

he didn't say a word.

He was humiliated and denied justice

No one will be able to tell about his descendants,

because his life on earth has come to an end"

- But the official didn't understand the scriptures. So he asked Philip to tell him what it meant. Philip told him the Good News about Jesus.
- Then they came to a place where they found water and Philip baptized the official. The eunuch was filled with joy.
- The spirit then took Philip to Azotus.

WHAT SHOWS THAT THE ETHIOPIAN EUNUCH WAS A GOD-FEARER?

1. He had been to Jerusalem to worship God
2. He was reading scriptures as he riding his carriage.

Themes

1. The Holy Spirit guides the church
2. Jesus works through the Holy Spirit
3. God's salvation is universal to both the Jews and Non Jews.

THE CONVERSION OF SAUL

(Acts 9: 1-19)

- Saul continued with his violent threats of murder against believers. He went to the High priest to take letters of introduction to the synagogue in Damascus so that he could also persecute the believers there
- But as he came near Damascus, the following happened to him;

1. A light from the sky flashed around him
 2. He fell to the ground
 3. He heard a voice calling him "Saul, Saul! Why do you persecute me?"
 4. He lost his sight (he became blind)
- The voice then told Saul to continue going into Damascus where he would be told what to do. So the men, who were travelling with him, led him into the city by hand because he couldn't see.

ANANIAS' VISION

- There was a believer in Damascus named Ananias. He had a vision in which the Lord appeared and told him to go to a house of a man named **Judas** and ask for a man named Saul from Tarsus.

ANANIAS REACTION TO THE VISION

1. He tried to resist because of terrible things that he had heard about Saul.
- But the Lord told Ananias to go for he had chosen him (Saul) to make his name known to the Gentiles, the kings and to the people of Israel.
- So Ananias went to the house of Judas where he prayed for Saul in order to see again and receive the Holy Spirit.
- After Ananias had prayed for him;
1. Saul received his sight again
 2. Saul was baptized

SAUL PREACHES IN DAMASCUS

(Acts 9:20-25)

- Few days after later, Saul went into in the synagogue and started preaching about Jesus. His preaching became more powerful and his proofs that Jesus was the Messiah were so convincing such that Jews in Damascus failed to answer him.

REACTION OF THE PEOPLE IN DAMASCUS TO SAUL'S PREACHING ABOUT JESUS

- When the people in Damascus heard that Saul had started preaching about Jesus;
 1. They were amazed because they had known Saul as a murder.
 2. Jews met together and planned to kill him
- But Saul's followers helped him get out the city safely buy **lowering him in a basket through an opening in a wall.**

Note: In Damascus Saul stayed in the house of a man named **Judas**

SAUL IN JERUSALEM

(Acts 9:26-31)

- Having safely escaped from Damascus, Saul went back to Jerusalem where he tried to join the disciples.
- Again in Jerusalem, when Saul tried to join the believers;
 1. The believers didn't not believe that Saul had indeed become a disciple.
 2. They all became afraid of him.
- So Barnabas took Saul to the apostles where he;
 - i. Explained to the apostles how Saul had seen the Lord on his way to Damascus.
 - ii. Also explained to the apostles how the Lord had spoken to Saul

iii. Also told them how boldly Saul had preached about Jesus in Damascus.

- Saul continued preaching about Jesus in Jerusalem. He also disputed with Greek- Speaking Jews who planned to kill him but when the believers knew this, they took Saul to Caesarea and sent him to Tarsus.

PETER IN LYDDA AND JOPPA

(Acts 9:32-43)

- On one occasion Peter came to Lydda to visit God's people. There, he met and healed a man named **Aeneas** who had been paralysed for **8 years** and was bed ridden all this time.

HOW PETER HEALED AENEAS IN LYDDA

- Peter simply ordered Aeneas to get up because Jesus had made him well. At once Aeneas was healed and he got up.

People's reaction to the healing of Aeneas in Lydda.

When the people of Lydda and Sharon saw what had happened

1. They turned to the Lord.

Theme

1. God saves mankind through Jesus

PETER IN JOPPA

- In Joppa there was a believer named Tabitha (Dorcas in Greek meaning a deer). She spent her time **doing good and helping the poor**. At that time she became ill and finally died. When the believers in Joppa heard that Peter was in Lydda, they sent for him.

- When Peter arrived, they took him to the upper room where they had placed Tabitha's body. There, the widows cried and showed Peter shirts and coats that Dorcas had made while alive.
- Peter then put the mourners out of the room and prayed for Tabitha to rise.

HOW PETER RAISED TABITHA TO LIFE

In the upper room Peter knelt down and prayed. Then he turned to body of Tabitha and ordered her to get up. At once Tabitha opened her eyes and sat up. Then Peter helped her get up and presented her to the people.

People's reaction

When the people heard what had happen

1. They believed in the Lord.

Themes

1. Prayer is vital for the life of the church
2. God saves mankind through Jesus

NOTE. In Joppa, Peter stayed with a man named **Simon** the tanner of leather.

PETER AND CORNEIUS

(Acts 10:1-33)

In Caesarea there was a man named Cornelius

Who was Cornelius?

1. He was a Roman centurion

2. He was a Gentile who together with his family worshipped Israel's God.
3. He was generous man who helped poor Jewish people.
4. He constantly prayed to God.

One afternoon Cornelius had a vision in which the angel of the Lord appeared to him and told him that God was pleased with his prayers and

charity works and He was ready to answer him. The angel then told him (Cornelius) to send for Simon Peter who was in Joppa.

So Cornelius then sent three men to Joppa for Peter.

➤ Mean while Peter too had a vision in Joppa

PETER'S VISION IN JOPPA.

In the vision, Peter saw heaven opened. And then he saw something that looked like a four-cornered sheet with all kinds of animals including reptiles and birds in it being lowered to the earth. Then a voice said to him, "Get up Peter, kill and eat."

But Peter said that he had never eaten anything ritually unclean or defiled.

The voice spoke to him again not to consider anything unclean that God had declared clean. This happened three times and the sheet was then taken back into heaven.

Meaning of the vision; Both Jews and Gentles were equal before God

- Peter was still wondering about the meaning of the vision when the Spirit told him to go down for three men were looking for him and he was to go with them to Caesarea. So Peter went with them to Caesarea.

- When they arrived, Peter found Cornelius and his relatives as well friends waiting for him. As soon as Cornelius saw Peter;
 1. He fell at his feet
 2. He bowed down before him.

PETER'S SPEECH TO THE GENTILES IN CAESAREA

1. I now see that God treats everyone on the same basis.
2. God poured His spirit on Jesus and he performed many healing miracles
3. We are the witnesses to all this
4. Jesus was put to death but God raised him up, we ate and drank with him.
5. He is the judge
6. Everyone who believes in him is forgiven.

GENTILES RECEIVE HOLY SPIRIT.

- As Peter was speaking, the Holy Spirit came down on all those who were listening to his message
- Jewish believers who had gone with Peter from Joppa were amazed to see God pouring H. Spirit on Gentiles also.
- The Gentiles who had received the Holy Spirit;
 1. They spoke in strange tongues
 2. They praised God's greatness
- Peter then baptized them with water

Themes

1. God's salvation is universal

2. The Holy Spirit guides the church
3. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible

PETER'S REPORT TO THE CHURCH AT JERUSALEM

(Acts 11:1-18)

- All believers in Judea heard that Gentiles had also received the Holy Spirit.
- When Peter returned to Jerusalem, he gave the believers a complete account of what had happened. However, he was accused of;
 - i. associating with uncircumcised Gentiles
 - ii. eating with uncircumcised Gentiles.
- After Peter had given a complete report,
 - i. They stopped criticizing him
 - ii. They praised God for giving Gentiles opportunity to repent and live.

THE CHURCH AT ANTIOCH

(Acts 11:19-30)

- Some of the believers who were scattered by persecution went to Antioch where they proclaimed message to the Gentiles also. And many people believed.
- When the news about this reached the church in Jerusalem, they sent Barnabas to Antioch **where he encouraged the believers to remain faithful and true to the Lord with all their hearts.**
- Then Barnabas went to take Saul from Tarsus. The two continued proclaiming the message together at Antioch.
- At that time Prophet **Agabus** went from Jerusalem to Antioch where by the power of the spirit, he predicted of the severe famine that would come over all the earth.

- So the believers at Antioch contributed some money to help their fellow believers who lived in Judea. They sent the money to the church elders by Barnabas and Saul.

Note: **Believers** were first called **Christians** at Antioch

MORE PERSECUTIONS

(Acts 12:1-5)

How King Herod Agrippa I persecuted the church?

1. By killing the believers e.g. James the brother of John
 2. By arresting the believers e.g. Peter
- After killing James and saw that it pleased the Jews, King Herod Agrippa arrested Peter. He put him in jail waiting for trial after the Passover. Mean while the church earnestly prayed for Peter to be released and the angel freed him.

HOW WAS PETER SET FREE FROM PRISON

(Acts 12:6-19)

As Peter was sleeping between two guards while tied with two chains, suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared to him and the light shone in the cell. The angel then shook Peter by the shoulder and woke him up. At once the chains fell off Peter's hands. The angel then told Peter to fasten his belt, put on his sandals and cloak and follow him (angel) as he led Peter out. Peter followed. Then they came to the iron gate that opened by itself and they went out and came down the street where the angel left him.

- Having been released from prison, Peter went to the home of Mary the mother of John Mark where believers had gathered for prayers. He was first recognized by a servant named **Rhoda**.
- The following morning, there was confusion at the prison since Peter could not be found in prison. SO King Herod ordered the guards to be put to death.

Themes

1. The church shares in the suffering of Jesus
2. Prayer is vital for the life of the church
3. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible

DEATH OF KING HEROD AGRIPPA I

(Acts 12:20-25)

King Herod died after the angel of the Lord struck him down because he didn't give honour to God by allowing the people call him god as he was addressing them.

BARNABAS AND SAUL ARE CHOSEN AND SENT -PAUL'S FIRST MISSIONARY JOURNEY (Acts Chapters 13 & 14)

Who is this Saul?

- Is the one who prosecuted the Church and whom God converted on his way to Damascus
- He was born in Tarsus with a Hebrew name "Saul" which in Greek was "Paul"
- He came to Jerusalem as a young man to be educated by Gamaliel.
- He was both a Jew and a Roman Citizen

- The church at Antioch had both prophets and teachers who included
 1. Barnabas 2. Simeon (called the Black) 3. Lucius (from Cyrene)
 4. Manaen and 5. Saul
- As they served the Lord and fasted, the Holy Spirit told them to set apart and send Barnabas and Saul on missionary.
- Having been sent by the Holy Spirit, **Barnabas** and **Saul** (Paul) came to the Island of Cyprus then at **Paphos** where they met with a magician named **Bar-Jesus** (Elymas in Greek)

Who was this Magician (Bar-Jesus?)

1. He was a Jew who claimed to be a great prophet.
 2. He was the best friend of **Sergius Paulus**- who was an intelligent man and the governor of the Island
- Governor Sergius Paulus called Barnabas and Saul in order to hear the word of God. But the magician (Bar-Jesus) tried to prevent the apostles from meeting the governor. Paul was filled with the Holy Spirit and rebuked him.

PAUL'S SPEECH TO BAR-JESUS

1. You the son of devil
 2. You are the enemy of everything that is good
 3. You are full of all kinds of evil tricks
 4. You turn the Lord's truth into lies
 5. The Lord's hand will come down on you and you will be blind.
- At once Bar-Jesus became blind

REACTION OF GOVERNOR SERGIUS PAULUS TO WHAT HAPPENED

1. He was greatly amazed

2. He believed in the Lord

NOTE: John Mark went along with Paul and Barnabas but returned to Jerusalem at Perga.

Themes

1. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible
2. The Holy Spirit guides the church
3. God saves mankind through Jesus.

PAUL AND BARNABAS IN ANTIOCH IN PISIDIA.

(Acts 13:13-52)

- From the Island of Cyprus at Paphos, Paul and Barnabas came to Perga where **John Mark** returned to Jerusalem. Then they arrived in Antioch in Pisidia.
- On the Sabbath, Paul and Barnabas went into the synagogue.
- After reading from the Law of Moses and the writings of the prophets, the synagogue's officials gave the apostles opportunity to address the people in the synagogue. Paul stood up and spoke to them.

PAUL'S SPEECH TO THE PEOPLE IN ANTIOCH IN PISIDIA

1. Fellow – Israelites and all Gentiles who worship God, hear me
2. God chose our ancestors and made them a great nation in Egypt
3. He brought them out of Egypt by His power.
4. God destroyed nations in Canaan and made His people owners of the land
5. Then He gave them judges and kings including David
6. It is Jesus a descendant of David whom God made a Saviour of His people.
7. Jesus was put to death but God raised him.
8. For many days he appeared to his witnesses

9. We are here to bring Good News to you
10. Through Jesus sins are forgiven and those who believe in him are set free.

PEOPLE'S REACTION TO PAUL'S SPEECH

1. Many Jews and Gentiles were converted to Judaism
 2. They were impressed with Paul's message such that they invited the apostle to come and talk to them again the following Sabbath.
- The following Sabbath, many people came to hear the word of God from the apostles. But when the Jews saw the crowd
 - i. They became jealousy
 - ii. They disputed what Paul was teaching the people
 - iii. They insulted Paul
 - But the apostles spoke out with boldness and told the Jews that since they had rejected God's salvation, the apostles would preach about it to the Gentiles.
 - When the Gentiles heard this;
 - i. They became glad
 - ii. They praised the Lord's message
 - iii. Those who had been chosen for eternal life became believers.
 - But the Jews stirred up some men and Gentile women. They started persecution against Paul and Barnabas and threw them out of their region. The apostles shook the dust off their feet in protest against them and went to **Iconium**.

Themes

1. The church shares in the suffering of Jesus

2. God saves mankind through Jesus
3. God's salvation is universal

PAUL AND BARNABAS IN ICONIUM

(Acts 14:1-7)

- In Iconium, Paul and Barnabas also taught the people in the synagogue and many Jews and Gentiles became believers. However, some Jews did not believe so they stirred up the Gentiles and turned against those who had believed.
- The city was divided – some people were for apostles while others were for the Jews (those that had not believed). So these Jews and some Gentiles decided to ill-treat and stone the apostles. When they knew this, the apostles escaped to Lystra and then went to Derbe

PAUL AND BARNABAS IN LYSTRA

(Acts 14:8-20)

- In Lystra, the apostles found a lame man. This man had been lame from birth and had never been able to walk. As Paul was teaching, the lame man listened. Paul saw that the man had believed and could be healed so he healed him.

HOW PAUL HEALED A LAME MAN IN LYSTRA?

Paul looked straight at the lame man and ordered him to stand up straight on his feet. At once the man was healed and he jumped up and started walking around.

PEOPLE'S REACTION TO THE HEALING OF THE LAME MAN IN LYSTRA

- When the people saw that the lame man had been healed

1. They shouted in their own Lycaonian language- **“the gods have become like men and have come down to us.”**
2. They gave the apostles names. Barnabas was given the name Zeus and **Paul “Hermes” because was the chief speaker**
3. They wanted to offer sacrifice to the apostles.

THE APOSTLES’ REACTION TO THE PEOPLE’S PLAN TO OFFER SACRIFICE TO THEM.

- When the apostles learnt that the crowd wanted to offer sacrifice to them;
 1. They tore their clothes
 2. They ran into the middle of the crowd
 3. They shouted to stop the people from offering sacrifice
- Then Paul addressed the people

PAUL’S SPEECH TO THE PEOPLE IN LYSTRA

1. We ourselves are just humans like you
 2. We are here to announce Good News to you
 3. There is only one true God who is the creator of everything
 4. In the past He allowed you to live in ignorance but He didn’t stop showing His power and love by giving you rains and harvests
 5. Turn away from your false gods.
- But some Jews who had come from **Antioch in Pisidia** and **Iconium** won the crowd over their side. They stoned Paul and dragged him out of the town.

Themes

1. The church shares in the suffering of Jesus
2. God saves mankind through Jesus.

THE RETURN TO ANTIOCH IN SYRIA

(Acts 14:21-28)

- The apostles preached Good News in Derbe and won many believers. Then they returned to Antioch passing through all cities/places where they had preached the Good News. In these they encouraged the believers to remain true to faith. They also appointed church elders and commended them to the Lord.

THE MEETING AT JERUSALEM

(Acts 15:1-21)

- Some men went from Judea to Antioch where they started teaching the Gentile believers that they were to be circumcised if they wanted to be saved.
- What these men demanded were;
 1. The Gentile believers were to be circumcised
 2. The Gentile believers were to be taught to obey the Law of Moses.
- Paul and Barnabas strongly argued with them however it didn't work. So they decided to meet the apostles and church elders in Jerusalem over this matter.
- In Jerusalem the apostles and elders met together to discuss the matter hence "***The meeting at Jerusalem***"
- At the meeting, Peter stood up and spoke.

PETER'S CONTRIBUTIONS AT THE MEETING

1. Brothers and sisters, You know God chose me long time ago to preach Good News to the Gentiles
2. God who knows our thoughts showed his approval of the Gentiles

3. He gave them Holy Spirit just as he did to us
 4. He forgave their sins because they believed
 5. We must not therefore burden them (Gentiles believers) with our old Law which even we Jews find hard to follow
 6. We are all saved by the grace of the Lord Jesus.
- The whole group was silent as they heard Barnabas and Paul report what God had performed among Gentiles. Then James rose and spoke also.

JAMES' CONTRIBUTION (SPEECH) AT THE MEETING

1. My brothers and sisters, Simon has just explained how God showed his care for Gentiles.
 2. The words of the prophets agree with this
 3. We should not trouble Gentiles who are turning to God
 4. We should write them letter to advise them on what not to do.
- Finally, the council agreed with James decision of writing letters to Gentile believers advising them on what not to do.

THE LETTER TO THE GENTILE BELIEVERS

(15:22-35)

Contents of the apostles' letter to the Gentile Believers

1. We the apostles and elders greet you all our Gentile brothers who live in Antioch, Syria and Cilicia
2. We have heard that some who went from our group troubled and upset you by what they said
3. However they did not receive instruction from us.
4. We (the apostles and elders) met and agreed to send some messengers to you with letter

5. They will come with our dear friends Paul and Barnabas
 6. They (messengers) will tell you in person the same things we have written.
 7. The Holy Spirit and us have agreed not to put other burden on you; except the following
 - i. That you should not eat food offered to the idols
 - ii. You should not eat blood
 - iii. you should not eat animal that has been strangled
 - iv. you should refrain from sexual immorality.
- The apostles and elders sent the letter by **Judas** also called (**Barsabbas**) and **Silas** (as messengers) who went together with the apostles.
 - The messengers came to Antioch where they gathered Gentiles believers and gave them the letter.

Reaction of the Gentiles Believers to the letters

1. They were all filled with joy by the words of encouragement
- Then Judas and Silas who were also prophets encouraged them before returning to Jerusalem.

Themes

1. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible
2. God saves mankind through Jesus
3. God's salvation is universal

PAUL'S SECOND MISSIONARY JOURNEY

PAUL AND BARNABAS SEPARATE

(Acts 15:36-41)

Reason for their separation

- It was because Barnabas wanted John Mark to go with them on their second missionary journey but Paul did not want John Mark to go with them because he (John Mark) had not stayed with them up to the end of their first missionary journey instead he returned to Jerusalem. So there was a sharp argument and they finally separated.
- **Note** John Mark is said to be the Cousin of Barnabas.
- After separating, **Paul took Silas** and went with him on his missionary Journey. While **Barnabas took John Mark** and sailed off for Cyprus.

Theme

1. The Holy Spirit guides the Church

PAUL AND SILAS IN DERBE AND LYSTRA

(Acts 16:1-5)

- Paul and Silas travelled to Derbe and Lystra where they found a Christian named **Timothy**
- Timothy's mother who was also a Christian was a Jew but his father was a Greek. All believers in Lystra and Iconium spoke well of Timothy, so Paul circumcised him and took him along on his missionary journey.

PAUL'S VISION IN TROAS

(Acts 16:6-10)

- In Troas Paul had a vision in which he saw a Macedonian standing and begging him to go to Macedonia and help them.

So Paul and his companions went to Macedonia

Theme

1. The Holy Spirit guides the church

PAUL AND SILAS IN PHILIPPI- THE CONVERSION OF LYDIA

(Acts 16:11-15)

- In Philippi, Paul and Silas went to the riverside where they thought Jews would gather for prayers on Sabbath. There they taught the women who had gathered. One of these women was **Lydia**

Who was Lydia?

1. She was a woman from Thyatira
 2. She was a dealer in purple clothes
 3. She was a woman who worshipped God
- So the Lord opened Lydia's mind such that she paid much attention to Paul's teaching. She and the people of her family believed and were all baptized. Then they invited the apostles to her home.

Themes

1. God saves mankind through Jesus
2. The Holy Spirit guides the Church

THE ARREST OF PAUL AND SILAS IN PHILIPPI

(Acts 16: 16-40)

- One day as the apostles were going to the place of prayer, they were met by a demon possessed young servant woman. The evil spirit enabled her to predict the future. Because of this, her owners made a lot of money.

- For many days, she followed the apostles and shouted at them;
“these men are servants of the Most High God! They announce to you how you can be saved!”
- Pau got upset with her and she delivered her from the evil spirit.

HOW PAUL DELIVERED A DEMON POSSESSED YOUNG LADY IN PHILIPPI

Paul ordered the evil spirit in the name of Jesus Christ to come out of young woman. At once the evil spirit went out of her and she was freed.

- When her owners realized that they would no longer make money since the evil spirit that enabled the young girl predict the future had gone out, they seized Paul and Silas and dragged them to the authorities.

ACCUSSIONS LEVELLED AGAINST PAUL AND SILAS BEFORE THE AUTHORITIES IN PHILIPPI

The owners of the young girl

1. Accused the apostles of causing troubles in their city.
 2. They also accused the apostles of teaching customs that were against their law.
- When the people heard these;
 1. They joined in attack against Paul and Silas
 2. The officials tore the clothes off the apostles
 3. The officials ordered the apostles to be whipped
 - After severe beating, they put the apostles in jail. About midnight, Paul and Silas started praising and singing hymns to God while other prisoners listened to them.

- Suddenly there was a violent earth quake that shook prison foundations and;
 - i. All the prison doors opened
 - ii. Chains fell off the prisoners
- When the Jailer saw that all prison doors were wide open he thought that the prisoners had escaped and he wanted to kill himself. But Paul told him that they (prisoners) were all in the prison. Then the jailer came and fell at the apostles' feet while trembling. Then he led the apostles out and asked them what he could do to be saved.
- The apostles told him to believe in the Lord Jesus. Then they preached the word to the jailer and his family. They all believed and were baptized. At the same night, the jailer **washed the apostles' wounds** and then he took them to his house where he **gave them food to eat. The Jailer and his family were filled with joy because they had believed in God.**
- The following morning the Roman Authorities send police officers to tell the apostles to go free. But the apostles refused to be sent away in secret since they were whipped in public. They also told the police officers that they (apostles) were Roman Citizens. The police officers reported all this to the officials.

Reaction of the Roman officials when they heard that the apostles were Roman Citizens.

1. They became afraid
 2. They went to apologize to the apostles for what they had done.
- Then they asked the apostles to leave the city and they went out.

Themes related to the apostles experience in Philippi

1. God saves mankind through Jesus
 - the young girl was delivered from evil spirit.
 - the jailer and his family believed in God
2. The Church shares in the suffering of Jesus
 - apostles were arrested and beaten
3. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible
 - authorities tried to stop the apostles mission by putting them

in prison but it was unstoppable.

PAUL AND SILAS IN THESSALONICA

(Acts 17:1-9)

- In Thessalonica, Paul and Silas went to the synagogue and taught the people. They held discussion with the people and quoted and explained the scriptures to the people. They also proved from the scriptures that Messiah had to suffer and rise from death. As the result of apostles teaching, people were convinced and they believed. many leading women and a large group of Greeks who worshipped God also believed
- However some Jews became jealous. So they formed a mob. They set the whole city in uproar and attacked the home of a man named **Jason** in an attempt to find the apostles. But when they didn't find the apostles at Jason's house, the Jews dragged **Jason** and **other believers** to the city authorities.

Although the apostles were not present at the city authorities, but the Jews accused them of;

1. Causing trouble everywhere they go

2. Breaking the laws of the Emperor by saying that there is another king called Jesus.

While **Jason** was accused of keeping the apostles in his house

- Then the authorities made Jason and the believers pay the money to be released.

PAUL AND SILAS IN BEREIA

(Acts 17:10-15)

- Having been sent out of the city (Thessalonica) by the believers, The apostles came to Berea where they found more open-minded people than those in Thessalonica. The people in Berea listened to the apostles' message with eagerness. Following the apostles' teaching
 1. Many people believed
 2. Many Greek women and men also believed
- But when the unbelieving Jews in Thessalonica heard that Paul and Silas were preaching the word of God in Berea, they came to Berea where they stirred up the mob against them (apostles)
- The believers in Berea then sent Paul to Athens where he was later joined by Silas and Timothy who had remained in Thessalonica.

PAUL IN ATHENS

(Acts 17:16-34)

- In Athens Paul was greatly upset to see how full of idols the city was. So he heard discussions with the people in the synagogue. However he was argued by certain **Epicurean and Stoic teachers** who described Paul as an **"Ignorant show-off"**.

- When Paul taught about Jesus and resurrection, other people thought he was talking about foreign gods. So they brought Paul before the city council the Ereopagus .Then Paul addressed the council.

PAUL'S SPEECH BEFOR ETHE COUNCIL IN ATHENS

1. I see that you Athenians are very religious people worshipping even unknown gods.
2. God the creator does not live in temple made by human hands.
3. He does not need anything that we can supply by working for him.
4. From one human being He created all races on earth
5. God's nature is not like image of gold or silver that man can make
(*shows people's ignorance in worshiping man made gods or idols*)
6. The time of ignorance is now over. So repent because there will be judgment.
7. God appointed a man as a judge. We are sure of this because God raised this man from death.

PEOPLE'S REACTION TO PAUL'S SPEECH

- When the people heard Paul speaking about raising from death,
 - a. Some made fun of him (Paul)
 - b. Some were eager to listen to Paul's teaching again.
- When Paul finished teaching, some people believed his message. These included;
 1. A man named **Dionysius** – A member of the council
 2. A woman named **Damaris**

PAUL IN CORINTH

(Acts 18:1-17)

- From Athens, Paul came to Corinth where he met a man named **Aquila**

Who was Aquila?

- ✓ He was a Jew born in Pontus
- ✓ He had a wife named **Priscilla**
- ✓ They used to make tents (They were earning a living by making tents)
 - He and his wife Priscilla had just come to Corinth from Italy following an order by Claudius that all Jews should leave Rome.
 - Paul went to stay with them **because they were tent makers just as he was.**
 - Paul taught and testified to the Jews that Jesus is a Messiah. When they opposed him, he protested by shaking the dust from his clothes.
 - Then he went to live in the house of a Gentile named **Titius Justus.**
 - Justus was a God-fearer (worshipped God). His house was next to the synagogue. **Crispus** the leader of the synagogue and his family believed including many other people. and were all baptized.
 - One night Paul had a vision.

PAUL'S VISION IN CORINTH

In the vision the Lord told Paul not to be afraid but to keep on speaking. The Lord also told Paul not to give up for He was with him and no one would harm him for many people in Corinth were the Lord's people.

- Later Paul was seized and brought before Gallio the governor where the people accused Paul of;
 1. Persuading people to worship God in a way that was against the Law.
- Gallio refused to judge the case because it was a question of names and words and not criminal case against Paul
- The mob then seized the Sosthenes, the leader of the synagogue and beat him up.

NOTE: Silas and Timothy joined Paul in Corinth.

- Then Paul together with Aquila and Priscilla sailed off for Syria, and later to Ephesus where Paul left them.

APOLLOS IN EPHESUS AND CORINTH

(Acts 18:24-28)

Who was Apollos?

- ✓ He was a Jew born in Alexandria
 - ✓ He was an eloquent speaker
 - ✓ He had a thorough knowledge of the Scriptures
 - ✓ He had been well instructed in the Way of the Lord and he correctly proclaimed and taught facts about Jesus with great enthusiasm
 - ✓ However, Apollos knew the **baptism of John only**
- When Aquila and Priscilla heard him teaching, they took him home where **they correctly explained to him the Way of God.**
 - Apollos then decided to go to Corinth so the believers in Ephesus helped him by **writing to the believers in Corinth** (in the province of Achaia) **urging them to welcome him.**
 - When Apollos arrived in Corinth he was a great help to the believers there. He debated and defeated Jews in public debates.

PAUL'S THIRD MISSIONARY JOURNEY

PAUL IN EPHESUS

(Acts 19:1-10)

- When Apollos was in Corinth, Paul arrived in Ephesus where he met about 12 disciples who were also believers.

- Although they were believers, they had never heard anything about **Holy Spirit**. In addition, they had only received the baptism of John.
- Paul explained to them correctly what the baptism of John was all about. Then he;
 1. Baptized them in the name of Jesus
 2. Prayed for them and they all received the Holy Spirit. Such that they spoke in tongues and proclaimed God's message.
- Then Paul held discussions with the people in synagogue and tried to convince them about the Kingdom of God. However some didn't believe him. So Paul left them and took the believers into the Tyranus lecture hall where he held discussions with them.

THE SONS OF SCEVA

(Acts 19:11-20)

- God performed unusual miracles through Paul. His handkerchiefs and aprons would be taken to those who were ill and they would be healed and evil spirits would come out the them.
- Some Jews also tried to use the name of Lord Jesus to cast out evil spirits. Seven brothers the sons of Sceva the Jewish High Priest did this.
- But a man who had an evil spirit in him attacked them with violence and overpowered them.

So they (sons of Sceva)

- ✓ Ran away from the house where the man with evil spirit was
- ✓ Had their clothes torn off
- ✓ Got wounded

REACTION OF THE PEOPLE IN EPHESUS

- When both Jews and Gentiles heard this
 1. They were all filled with fear
 2. They gave name of the Lord Jesus a great honour
 3. Those who practiced magic brought their books together and burnt them up
 4. Believers came admitting and revealing what they had done.

RIOT IN EPHESUS

(Acts 19:21-41)

- After these had happened, Paul sent two of his helpers Timothy and Erastus to Macedonia while he himself spent time in Asia
- It was at this time when a riot started in Ephesus due to the Way of the Lord. Because Paul was teaching against worshipping man made gods (idols), this did not please **Demetrius** who made silver models of the temple of goddess Artemis and his fellow silversmiths in city.

Reasons why Demetrius and his fellow silversmiths opposed Paul's teaching

1. They were afraid that their business would get a bad name
 2. They were afraid that the temple of the goddess Artemis would come to mean nothing
 3. They were afraid that the greatness of goddess Artemis would be destroyed
- So Demetrius gathered his fellow silversmiths and addressed them.

DEMETRIUS SPEECH TO HIS FELLOW SILVERSMITHS

1. Men you know that our prosperity comes from this work

2. Now hear what this fellow is doing
3. He is telling people that gods made by human hands are not gods at all and he has convinced many people
4. There is danger then that our business will get a bad name
5. Not only that, the temple of the goddess Artemis will come to mean nothing and her greatness will be destroyed.

PEOPL'S REACTION TO DEMETRIUS SPEECH

➤ When the crowd heard this;

1. They became furious
 2. They started shouting "*Great is Artemis of Ephesus*"
 3. They seized Gaius and Aristarchus and brought them to the theatre
- Gaius and Aristarchus were the two Macedonians who were travelling with Paul
- Paul wanted to follow them to the theatre but the **believers** and some **provincial authorities** who were his friends told him not to go.
- At the theatre, some Jews made Alexander go upfront to address the crowd. But when the people recognized that Alexander was a Jew, they started shouting.
- At last it was the **town clerk** who managed to calm the crowd

TOWN CLERK'S SPEECH TO THE RIOTING EPHESIANS

1. Fell Ephesians, everyone knows that our city is the keeper of the temple of great Artemis and sacred stone
2. You must calm down and not do anything reckless

3. You have brought these men here even though they have not robbed temples or said evil things about our goddess
 4. If Demetrius and his workers have accusations against anyone they can bring them before the authorities
 5. But if there is something that you want , then it has to be settled in the legal meeting of citizens
 6. There is danger that with what has happened we may be accused of riot and we will not be able to give a good reason for it.
- After speaking, the town clerk dismissed the meeting.

Themes

1. The church shares in the suffering of Jesus Christ
 - Gaius and Aristarchus were arrested
2. The author of Acts shows sympathy for the Romans
3. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible
4. The Holy Spirit guides the Church

PAUL'S LAST VISIT TO TROAS

(Acts 20:7-12)

- In Troas, people gathered together in the upstairs room for the fellowship meal. Then Paul spoke to them until midnight since he was going to leave the following day. One of those who listened to him was a young man named **Eutychus**. He sat by the window and listened to Paul. As Paul kept on talking Eutychus became sound asleep and finally fell from the third storey to the ground and died. But Paul **raised him to life**

PAUL'S MIRACLE IN TROAS

He raised a dead man named Eutychus to life

PAUL'S FAREWELL SPEECH TO CHURCH ELDERS OF EPHESUS

(Acts 20:17-38)

- While he was in Miletus, Paul sent a message to the church elders of Ephesus to meet him. When they all came Paul addressed them.

Paul's speech can be put into the following parts

1. His past efforts

- ✓ Paul recalled what he had done for them and the church in Ephesus.
 - When I was with you, I preached and taught in both public and in your homes and I worked with humility as the Lord's servant.

2. His future plans

- ✓ Paul told the church elders that the Holy Spirit had urged him to go to Jerusalem where he could suffer. He also told them that he was prepared to suffer or even to die but his wish was to be a true witness.

3. His advice to the church elders

- He told them that they were responsible for the church at Ephesus
- The Holy Spirit had made them overseers
- He advised them to be careful with false teachers who would come after him (Paul)

4. His own example and blessing

- Paul told them to trust in God and consider him as a good example. Instead of begging he worked for his own living so that he could help others.

PAUL GOES TO JERUSALEM

(Acts 21:1-18)

- After his meeting with the church elders, then Paul and his companions left for Jerusalem by ship. They arrived at **Tyre** where

they found some believers and stayed with them for a week.. By the power of the Spirit, the believers told Paul not to go to Jerusalem. But when their time was over, Paul and his companions left Tyre for Jerusalem. The believers escorted them to the beach where they all knelt down and prayed and then said goodbye to one another.

- Then they came to **Caesarea** and stayed at the house of **Philip** the evangelist

Who was Philip?

- ✓ He was an evangelist
 - ✓ He was one of the seven chosen helpers in **Acts chapter 6**
 - ✓ He four unmarried daughters who proclaimed God's message
- While Paul and his companions were still at Philip's house, **Prophet Agabus** from Judea arrived and took Paul's belt and tied up his own feet and hands with it. Then he said that was how the owner of the belt

(Paul) would be tied up by Jews in Jerusalem and handed over to Gentiles.

Reaction of Paul's companions to Agabus prophecy

1. They begged Paul not to go to Jerusalem

Paul's reaction

1. He told them that he was ready not only to be tied up in Jerusalem but also to die for the sake of Jesus.
- Then they came to Jerusalem and stayed in a house of a believer named **Mnason** from Cyprus

PAUL BACK IN JERUSALEM FROM THIRD MISSIONARY JOURNEY.

PAUL VISITS JAMES

(Acts 21:17-26)

- When Paul and his companions arrived in Jerusalem, the following day he went to meet James the leader of Jerusalem church and other church elders where he gave a complete report about what God had done to the Gentiles.

Reaction of the Jerusalem church elders to Paul's report

- When they heard Paul's report,
 1. They all praised God.
- Then the church elders told him about the rumours that were circulating among the Jews that he (Paul)
 1. Was teaching Jews living in Gentile countries to abandon the Law of Moses.
 2. Was telling the Jews not to circumcise their children
 3. Was telling Jews not to follow Jewish customs
- For him to show his disapproval of the accusations made against him, the church elders advised Paul to join four men in **purification ceremony** and he should pay their expenses. So Paul did as the elders had advised him. Then he went into the temple and gave notice of how many days it would be until the end of purification period.

PAUL IS ARRESTED IN THE TEMPLE IN JERUSALEM

(Acts 21:27-36)

Note: *The arrest of Paul in Jerusalem is fulfilling what prophet Agabus said in Caesarea. Acts 21:11*

- While Paul was still in the temple, some Jews from Asia saw him. They stirred up the crowd and seized Paul.

ACCUSATIONS JEWS LEVELLED AGAINST PAUL IN JERUSALEM

1. They accused him of teaching everyone against the people of Israel
2. They also accused him of teaching against the Law of Moses
3. They accuse him of teaching against their temple
4. They also accused him of defiling the temple

Reason why Jews accused Paul of defiling the temple in Jerusalem

- ✓ Because they had seen a Gentile named **Trophimus** in the city so they thought Paul taken him into the temple.
- Having arrested Paul, they dragged him out of the temple. They planned to kill Paul when the report was sent to the commander of the Roman troops (Claudius Lysias) that all Jerusalem was rioting. It was the commander and his men who rescued Paul from the irate Jews and they took him to the fort.

PAUL DEFENDS HIMSELF BEFORE THE PEOPLE.

- As soldiers were about to take Paul into the fort, he requested them to allow him to speak to the people

Paul's speech to the people

Paul's speech contained three principal parts namely;

1. **Introduction and his earlier attitude towards believers** – Paul told the people who he was and how he treated believers
2. **His conversion** – Paul told the people how he was converted to Christianity
3. **His call to preach to the Gentiles** – Paul told the people how his mission of preaching to the Gentiles started.

His whole speech

- I am a Jew born in Tarsus in Cilicia but brought up here in Jerusalem as student of Gamaliel .

- I received the strict instruction in the Law of our ancestors and was just dedicated as you all who are here
- I persecuted to death people who followed this way
- The High Priest and the council can prove that I am talking the truth
- I received letters of introduction from them so that I could arrest believers in Damascus.
- But as I came near Damascus, bright light from the sky flashed round me. I fell to the ground and heard a voice that told me to go into Damascus where I would be told what to do
- In Damascus, Ananias came and prayed for me and I received my sight again
- I went back to Jerusalem where while praying in the temple I had a vision in which the Lord told me to leave the city for people there could not accept my witness about Him. The Lord then told me that He would send me far away to the Gentiles.

People's reaction to Paul's speech

1. They started shouting at the top of their voices. "*away with him, Kill him*"
 2. They screamed
 3. They waved their clothes
 4. They threw dust in the air
- Then the Roman commander ordered his men to take Paul into the fort and told them to whip him in order to find out why Jews were screaming against him. As they were about to whip him, Paul asked the officer whether it was lawful to whip the **Roman Citizen** who had not been tried for any crime.
- The officer then reported to the commander that Paul was a Roman Citizen.

Note: The Roman commander said had become Roman citizen by paying money while Paul said was a Roman citizen by birth.

Reaction of the Roman commander and his men to Paul's citizenship.

When the commander learnt that Paul was a Roman citizen;

1. He was frightened that he had put a Roman citizen in chains.

PAUL BEFORE THE COUNCIL

(Acts 22:30, 23:1-11)

- The commander wanted to find out what the Jews were accusing Paul of, so he brought him before the council.
- When Paul had started defending himself before the council, High Priest Ananias ordered those who were close to Paul **to strike him on the mouth**. But Paul told the High Priest that God would strike him also for breaking the Law (*ordering his men to strike him*). When the men who were close to Paul heard this, **they accused him of insulting Go's High Priest**.
- When Paul saw that some people in the group were **Sadducees** while others were **Pharisees**, he said he was a Pharisee and that he was on trial because of his hope that the dead will rise to life. As soon as Paul said he was a Pharisee, the quarrel between the Pharisees and Sadducees started and the group was divided.

Remember; Pharisees believed in life after death While the Sadducees never believed in this.

- The argument between the Pharisees and Sadducees became violent so the commander ordered his men to take Paul back to the fort.

THE PLOT AGAINST PAUL'S LIFE.

(Acts 23:12-22)

- Some Jews made a plot against Paul. They vowed not to eat or drink until they had killed him. So they went to the chief priests and elders and told them to order Claudius Lysias to bring Paul before them. They had planned to kill Paul on the way as he would be going to appear before the council. But as they were discussing this plot, the son of Paul's sister heard them and he reported to Paul. Paul then told him to

tell the commander about the staged plot against him. When Claudius Lysias learnt about the plot, he sent Paul to **Governor Felix**

Themes

1. The church shares in the suffering of Jesus Christ
2. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible

PAUL IS SENT TO GOVERNOR FELIX

(Acts 23:23-35)

- Claudius Lysias sent Paul to governor Felix together with a letter

CONTENTS OF CLAUDIUS' LETTER TO GOVERNOR FELIX

1. Claudius Lysias to His Excellency governor Felix ; Greetings;
2. Jews seized this man and were about to kill him.
3. When I learnt that he is Roman citizen I with my soldiers went to rescue him.
4. I took him down to their council to find out what they were accusing him of, but I found out nothing for which he deserved to die or be put in prison
5. The accusations against him had to do with questions about their own law.

6. When I was informed that there was a plot against him, at once I decided to send him to you
7. I have told his accusers to make their charges against him before you.

- The soldiers took Paul and handed him over to Governor Felix in Caesarea.

PAUL BEFORE GOVERNOR FELIX

(Acts 24:1-9)

- Five days later the High Priest Ananias and some elders went to Caesarea. They hired a lawyer named **Tertullus** to accuse Paul before Governor Felix.

ACCUSATIONS TERTULLUS LEVELLED AGAINST PAUL BEFORE GOVERNOR FELIX

1. He accused Paul of starting riots among Jews
2. He accused Paul of defiling the temple
3. He accused Paul of being the leader of the party of Nazarenes

PAUL'S DEFENSE BEFORE GOVERNOR FELIX

- Then Paul spoke in self defence against Tertullus' accusations
 1. I went to Jerusalem to worship God
 2. Jews did not find me arguing with anyone in the temple nor stirring up the people.
 3. I worship God of our ancestors by following the Way which they say is false
 4. I also believe in everything written in the Law of Moses and the books of prophets

5. I have the same hope in God just as theirs that the dead will rise from death
 6. After being away from Jerusalem for a long time, I came to bring money to my people and offer sacrifices.
 7. It was while I was doing that they found me in the temple and there was no crowd with me.
 8. Only some Jews from Asia were there. and they also ought to come and make their accusations against me before you
 9. When I appeared before the council they found me not guilty of any crime except the belief that I have that the dead will rise to life.
- Then Governor Felix brought the hearing to close. He ordered the officer in charge of Paul to keep him under guard but to give him some freedom.

PAUL BEFORE GOVERNOR FELIX AND HIS WIFE DRUSILLA

(Acts 24:24-27)

- After some days later, Governor Felix came with his wife Drusilla a Jew. He sent for Paul and when he was brought before them, they listened as Paul talked about Faith in Christ. But when Paul started talking about ***goodness, self control and the Day of Judgment*** Felix became afraid and he sent Paul away.
- **Note:** Governor Felix left Paul in prison because he wanted to gain favour with the Jews.
- Later Felix was succeeded by **Porcius Festus** as governor

PAUL APPEALS TO THE EMPEROR

(Acts 25:1-12)

- Having succeeded Felix as governor, Porcius Festus went to Jerusalem where the chiefs priests and Jewish leaders brought their charges

against Paul to him. They requested him to do them favour by bringing Paul back to Jerusalem for trial. They did this with intention of killing Paul on the way. Few days later Festus went back to Caesarea together with some Jews from Jerusalem where they made charges against Paul before the governor.

- In defence, Paul told them that he had not done anything which was against the Jewish Laws, temple or Roman Emperor.
- Festus wanted to gain favour with the Jews, so he asked Paul if he could be tried before him in Jerusalem.

(Remember Jews had planned to kill Paul on the way)

- But Paul refused to go back to Jerusalem for trial instead he appealed to be tried before Emperor in Rome

Themes

1. The power of the Holy Spirit is irresistible
2. The Holy Spirit guides the church
3. The church shares in the suffering of Jesus.

PAUL BEFORE KING AGRIPPA AND BERNICE

(Acts 25:13-27)

Who was King Agrippa? (Also called King Agrippa II)

- ✓ He was the son of Herod Agrippa I and the great grandson of Herod the Great
- ✓ Bernice was his half sister whom he had married as his wife
- Some time King Agrippa and his wife Bernice came to Caesarea to pay a visit of welcome to Governor Festus.
- While still in Caesarea, Festus told King Agrippa about Paul's case. He brought Paul before King Agrippa so that after Agrippa had heard from

Paul, Festus could find something to write to the emperor about Paul's case.

PAUL DEFENDS HIMSELF BEFORE KING AGRIPPA

Acts (26:1-32)

- King Agrippa then told Paul to defend himself from all accusations that Jews were accusing him of. So Paul said;
 1. I consider it a fortune that I defend myself from the accusations that Jews have brought against me before you.
 2. You King Agrippa know well our religion and you will understand me
 3. I share the hope of all Jews by faith in resurrection and how can this be held against me?
 4. I actively opposed the way and went to Damascus to persecute the believers
 5. On the road to Damascus, I saw a vision and I was converted
 6. In obedience to the vision, I preached Jesus to both Jews and Gentiles, this is why fellow Jews want to kill me
 7. I testify that Jesus' life, death and his resurrection is the fulfillment of the law and prophets. Even our own witness also fulfills these.
- As Paul was defending himself, Festus shouted at him and told him that his great learning was driving him mad. On the other hand King Agrippa challenged Paul that could not convert him to Christianity within a short time.
- Just as Governor Festus, King Agrippa too did not find Paul guilty. Agrippa said Paul would have been released if he had not appealed to the emperor.

PAUL'S JOURNEY TO ROME

- Following his appeal to the emperor, governor Festus sent Paul to Rome together with other prisoners. He handed Paul and the other prisoners over to an officer named **Julius** (an officer in the Roman regiment).
- The officer was so **kind to Paul such that when they arrived at Sidon, he allowed Paul to go and see his friends and also to be given what he needed.**
- Paul was accompanied by Aristarchus a Macedonian from Thessalonica.
- When they arrived at a place called Safe Harbours, Paul predicted of the dangers ahead of their journey as the result of the bad weather. He said;
 1. The voyage was dangerous
 2. There would be a great damage to cargo and ship
 3. There would also be loss of life
- But the army officer did not take Paul's advice instead he was convinced by what the captain and the owner of the ship said.

THE SHIPWRECK

(Acts 27:39-44)

- As Paul and other prisoners together with the soldiers were sailing unfortunately the ship hit the sandbar and went aground. The front part got stuck and could not move while the back part got broken to pieces due to violent water waves. When the soldiers saw that the prisoners could swim ashore and escape, they planned to kill them. **However the army officer wanted to save Paul** so he stopped the soldiers from killing the prisoners. Instead he ordered those who could swim to jump overboard and swim ashore while the rest were to follow holding on to the planks or broken pieces of the ship. Through this, way they all got ashore safely.

PAUL IN MALTA

(Acts 28:1-10)

- In Malta, the natives were very friendly to Paul and his companions. They lit them fire to warm themselves since it was cold and also raining. Paul gathered some sticks and was putting them on the fire when a snake came out and fastened itself to his hand.

- When the natives saw the snake hanging on Paul's hand **they said to one another that Paul was a murderer**. They waited for either of the following to happen to him;
 1. Either Paul would swell up, or
 2. He would suddenly die

- After waiting for a long time and saw nothing unusual was happening to Paul, **they changed their minds and said Paul was a god**.
- The chief official of the Malta Island Publius welcomed Paul and his companions very kindly. He made them his guest at his house for three days. Publius' father was sick from **fever** and **dysentery**. Paul prayed for him and was healed. Many other sick people in the island came and Paul healed them.
- Then the natives gave Paul and his companions many gifts and also put on board what they needed on the voyage.

PAUL IN ROME.

(Acts 28:16-31)

- In Rome Paul was allowed to live by himself with a soldier guarding him. After three days he called the local Jewish leaders to a meeting.

PAUL'S SPEECH TO THE LOCAL JEWISH LEADERS IN ROME

1. My fellow- Israelites though I did nothing against our people or customs, I was made prisoner in Jerusalem and handed to Romans.
 2. The Romans found me innocent and wanted to release me but the Jews opposed this.
 3. So I was forced to appeal to the emperor though I don't have any accusation against my own people.
 4. I am bound in chains because of the hope we share as Jews.
- The Jewish leaders told Paul that they had not received any letters from Judea or any of their people reporting bad things about Paul. Since they were very interested to hear Paul's ideas, so they fixed a date to meet again.
 - On the fixed date, many people came. Paul spoke to them about the Kingdom of God. He quoted the Law of Moses and the writing of the prophets to convince them. Some believed his teaching while others never believed.
 - Paul quoted from the book of Isaiah

END OF THE BOOK OF ACTS OF APOSTLES

Bible Knowledge Paper II Sample Questions

1. Acts 6:1-7 is about the choice of seven helpers

- a. What prompted the apostles to call for the elections of the seven helpers

(2 marks)

- b. Name any **three** of the seven chosen helpers

(6marks)

- c. Describe three qualities of the seven helpers that were elected

(6marks)

2. Acts 19:21-41 is about riot in Ephesus

- a. Why did Demetrius and his fellow silversmith oppose Paul's teaching?
Give **two** reasons

(4 marks)

- b. Relate Demetrius speech to fellow silversmith

(8marks)

- c. In what **three** ways did the crowd react to Demetrius speech?

(6marks)

- d. Outline any **three** contents of the town clerk's speech

(6marks)

- e. Mention any **two** themes illustrated by Paul's experience in Ephesus

(4marks)

END OF QUESTION PAPER

NB. This paper contains 2 pages